



Fig. 7: Typical RasPlex window

load torrents and add these to the queue. Raspi will keep downloading these. If you want to save all downloads in an NAS drive, you will have to configure it separately. For now, everything goes in Home folder.

RasPlex, a beautiful media centre

RasPlex is much more handy and easy to install as compared to Raspbmc media centre. I find its performance quite amazing.

RasPlex divides the overall XBMC functionality into two parts, making it amazingly lightweight. The client runs on Raspi but the server is installed on another computer.

For setting up Plex server on your computer, download the Plex server from <https://plex.tv/downloads>. It may automatically detect your OS but if not, select the right one manually. Install the downloaded file.

After installation, the server runs in Menu tray. To access it, just click on System Tray and select Media Manager. Add media to the server by clicking +. Select media type, name the collection and point to the right directory.

Note that, Plex only understands a proper folder structure. You need to have two folders: Movies and TV Shows. Under Movies, each movie

should have its own subfolder. Under TV Shows, each series should have a different subfolder.

For setting up RasPlex on Raspberry Pi, follow the steps as given below:

1. Download RasPlex from www.raspdex.com/get-started/raspdex-installers.html
2. Insert Raspi's SD card in your computer. Format SD card to FAT
3. Right-click on the downloaded file and run as administrator
4. Select the latest version and your SD card in GetRaspdex window and click Download

Now, put the SD card back in Raspi, connect it to the TV using HDMI, connect the Internet to both server and Raspi, and power everything up. Do connect the keyboard to navigate the initial startup. Once set up, it will automatically connect to the server and start fetching all media. A typical RasPlex window is shown in Fig. 7. You can even control it with a smartphone but that is out of scope for this article. ●



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